SI-native

Build an AI business or department on semantic intelligence — without building in debt. The couplings are drawn deliberately, while it's still cheap.

In brief. You want to build an AI business or department from scratch. It's the rare chance to draw the couplings deliberately — and to build the **semantic layer before the agent**, so you don't inherit debt.

01 THE RARE CHANCE

Building new is rare. Most inherit a platform, a habit, a tool. You don't. That means you can draw things deliberately — instead of discovering them afterward.

But the chance is short. Governance is what you build afterward to compensate for something no one owns. Build right from the start, and you skip most of it.

02 BUILD THE SEMANTIC LAYER BEFORE THE AGENT

It's the mistake everyone makes: the agent first, the concepts after. Then 'case' gets **fourteen meanings**, and the agent's answers can't be checked. Reverse the order.

Write your concepts down. Versioned. With **an owner**. Only then is the first agent written. Then it understands your reality from the start — not just the language.

Concepts first. Then the agent.

03 DRAW THE COUPLINGS DELIBERATELY

- Agent ↔ data: what it fetches, from which source, which version — and who owns it.
- Agent ↔ agent: when one agent uses another, how the link is checked.
- Output ↔ decision: when an answer becomes an action, and who answers for it.

A SYNTHETIC EXAMPLE

→ A new company builds an SI-native department from scratch.

→ They spend two days writing their concepts down and giving each coupling **an owner**, before the first agent goes live.

→ A year later they scale without stopping. No concept with **fourteen meanings**, no loose coupling to clean up.

→ The governance apparatus they skipped would have cost more than the two days — every year.

04 DO IT NOW, WHILE IT'S CHEAP

Checklist for SI-native

- ☐ Are your concepts written down, versioned and owned — before the first agent?
- ☐ Do you know what each agent fetches, and who owns the source?
- ☐ Can every agent-to-agent link be checked?
- ☐ Is it clear when an answer becomes an action — and who answers?
- ☐ Are you building the semantic layer first, or the agent first?

05 LOOPLO SERVICES — WHAT WE TAKE CARE OF

The domains each have an owner. The seams between them have none — those are what we take care of. The coupling is no one's table; we make sure ownership lands in the right place. Here is the full catalogue: five couplings and the gate that makes them raisable.

LAYER	WHAT THE FIELD GOVERNS	WHAT WE TAKE CARE OF	DELIVERABLE
I · Data foundations	Source of record, lineage, consent, field access	The seam between data and the systems that use it	Coupling map with a named owner at every crossing
II · Decision definitions	Semantic layer, glossary, definition register	The number that means one thing in the boardroom and another in the model	Semantic reconciliation; one definition authority
III · Output controls	Guardrails, hallucination checks, redaction, review	When an unverified output becomes an acted-on fact	Control chain from output to decision
IV · Agent governance	Allowed actions, permissions, override, kill switch	What the agent may do — vs. who answers when it does	Rights matrix bound to named owners
V · Accountable autonomy	Risk register, model cards, incident response	When scale outruns ownership	Accountability architecture and board-facing assurance
Gate · Psychological safety	—	An unowned dependency is usually one no one feels safe to raise	The enabling condition for every layer

06 EFFECT AND CONSEQUENCE

Governance built afterward is expensive. **One in three AI projects** is expected to be shut down by 2027 (Gartner) — most on the coupling. Build the **concepts first** and the couplings deliberately, and it's the **cheapest governance** there is: the kind you don't need.

IN SHORT · LOOPLO TAKES CARE OF THE COUPLING

Build the semantic layer before the agent, and give each coupling an owner from day one. Every yes now is a bill you skip later. — book a short meeting at cal.com/jacobfalkentorp.